Certificate Status Workflow

Transition rules currently in effect — for your review and sign-off

PREPARED BY	PREPARED	STATUS
Anuki Consulting	July 14, 2026	Awaiting sign-off

Purpose

Your certificate records move through a defined set of statuses over their lifecycle. This document lays out the rules that control **which status a certificate may move to next**, so you can confirm they match how your business actually works — or tell us what to change. Reviewing this document changes nothing in the system; it is for your verification only.

Background

Earlier this year, as part of a security update, we added rules that govern how a certificate moves from one status to the next — so a record can't accidentally be placed in a state that doesn't reflect where it actually is in the process. Before that update, the edit screen accepted any status change without checking.

The **eight statuses themselves were defined by your team.** The specific rules for *which status may follow which* were set by our team during that security update and have not yet been formally reviewed with you. That is the reason for this document.

The eight certificate statuses

#	Status	Meaning
1	**Draft**	Initial working state; not yet approved.
2	**Client Approved – Not Paid**	Approved by the client, payment outstanding.
3	**Client Approved – Confidential**	Approved and paid, but kept private (not shown publicly).
4	**Client Approved – Paid**	Approved and paid; publicly visible.
5	**Hold**	Temporarily paused.
6	**Expired**	Past its expiration date.
7	**Republished**	A previously-live certificate re-issued with a fresh term; publicly visible.
8	**Expired – No Annual Verification**	Expired because the annual verification was not completed.

Publicly visible statuses: Client Approved – Paid and Republished only.

Which status may follow which

From its current status, a certificate may only move to the statuses listed below.

Current status	May move to
Draft	Client Approved – Not Paid · Confidential · Paid · Hold
Client Approved – Not Paid	Paid · Confidential · Hold · Expired
Client Approved – Confidential	Paid · Hold · Expired
Client Approved – Paid	Hold · Expired · Republished · Expired – No Annual Verification
Hold	Draft · Not Paid · Confidential · Paid
Expired	Republished · Draft
Republished	Expired · Expired – No Annual Verification · Hold
Expired – No Annual Verification	Draft

Complete scenario grid

Every possible change, at a glance. Read a row as the *current* status and a column as the *target* status.

From ↓ To →	Draft	Not Paid	Confid.	Paid	Hold	Expired	Repub.	Exp-NAV
Draft	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Not Paid	✗	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Confidential	✗	✗	—	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Paid	✗	✗	✗	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Hold	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	✗	✗	✗
Expired	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	—	✓	✗
Republished	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	—	✓
Exp-NAV	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	—

Allowed Blocked Same status (n/a)

The scenario that prompted this review

Moving a certificate directly from **Draft** → **Republished** is currently **blocked**. Republished can only be reached from **Client Approved – Paid** or **Expired**, because it means a previously-live certificate is being re-issued. This is a rule to confirm — not a system fault. The sign-off section below includes a specific Yes/No line for it.

Automatic exceptions

Three behaviors intentionally override the rules above. Please confirm they are still what you want.

1. **Automatic expiry on save.** If a certificate's expiration date is already in the past when it is saved, its status is automatically set to **Expired**, regardless of the rules above.
2. **Correcting an expiration date.** If a certificate expired automatically and you later move its expiration date back to today or the future, the system restores the status it held just before it expired — even where the rules above wouldn't otherwise allow that step. This lets you undo a date-driven expiry.
3. **Overnight expiry check.** An automated nightly process moves any active certificate whose expiration date has passed to **Expired**.

Who can change status

- **Analysts and Administrators** may move a certificate to any status permitted by the rules above.
- **External users** may only create certificates in **Draft**; they cannot change status.

> **A note on the editing experience.** When the block first appeared, the edit screen kept your rejected choice selected, which made it feel like you were locked out (nothing was ever lost). This has already been corrected

> in the upcoming update: the status field now returns to the certificate's real status, and the message lists exactly which statuses you can move to. No action is needed — noted here for completeness.

Client sign-off

For each rule set, mark **Confirm** if the rule is correct, or note the change you'd like.

Rule set	Confirm	Requested change / notes
Draft → Not Paid · Confidential · Paid · Hold	☐	
Not Paid → Paid · Confidential · Hold · Expired	☐	
Confidential → Paid · Hold · Expired	☐	
Paid → Hold · Expired · Republished · Exp-NAV	☐	
Hold → Draft · Not Paid · Confidential · Paid	☐	
Expired → Republished · Draft	☐	
Republished → Expired · Exp-NAV · Hold	☐	
Exp-NAV → Draft	☐	
Should Draft → Republished be allowed?	☐ Yes ☐ No	
Automatic exceptions 1–3 (above) are correct	☐	

Signature _____ Name & title _____ Date _____